Illustrative Example of Pricing Mechanisms on DiDi's Ride-Pooling Platform

Figure 1 provides an illustrative example of the pricing mechanism used by DiDi Chuxing. Before the matching process begins, the platform already displays a non-pooled price together with a pooled price quote. This suggests that, in practice, the platform first generates a baseline price using simple trip-related information and then further adjusts the displayed pooled price according to the expected pooled service mode.

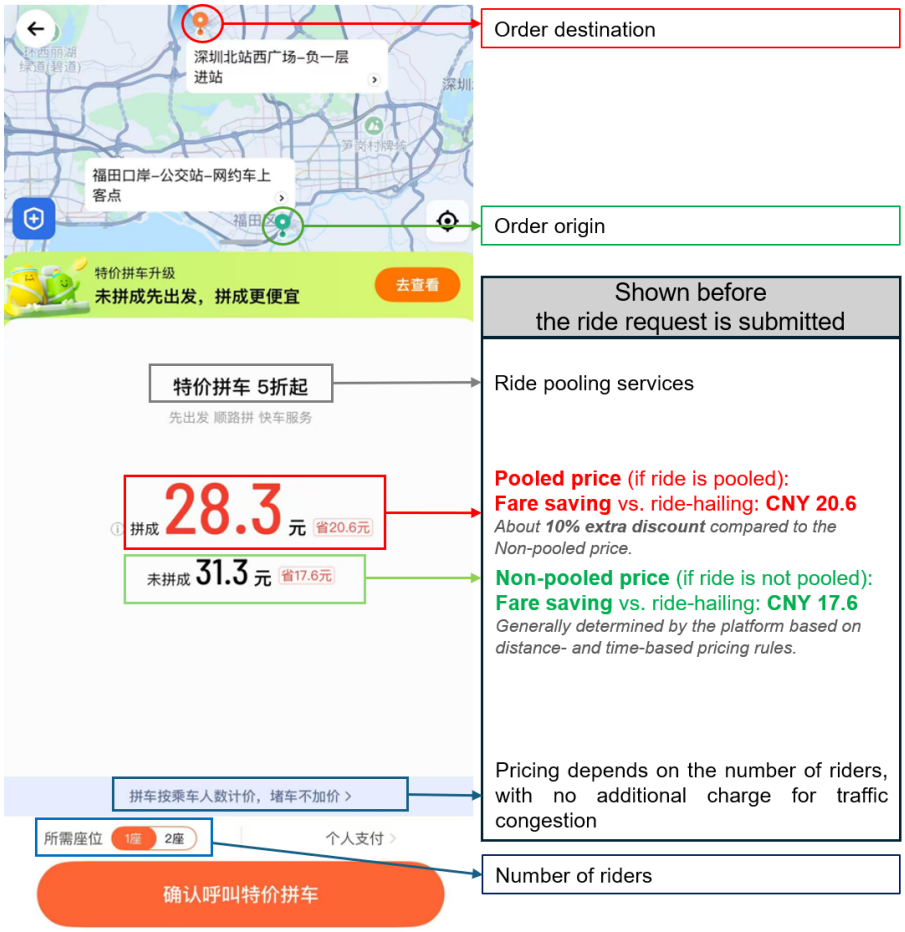


Figure 1: Screenshot of DiDi's ride-pooling pricing interface.

This observation is consistent with our modeling assumption that the baseline price p_r is given before optimization, rather than treated as a fully flexible decision variable. In this sense, using a reasonable pre-estimated baseline price as model input is well aligned with actual ride-pooling platform practice.